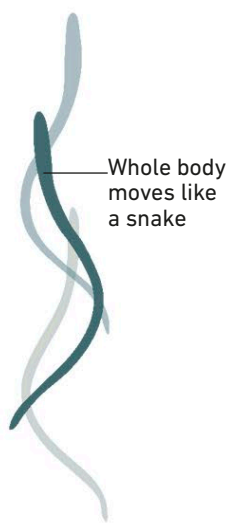
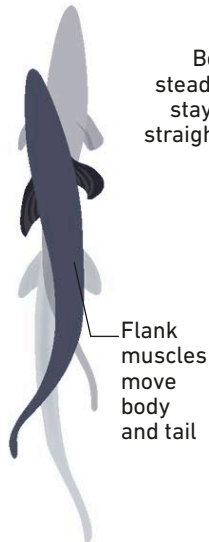


SWIMMING LIKE A FISH



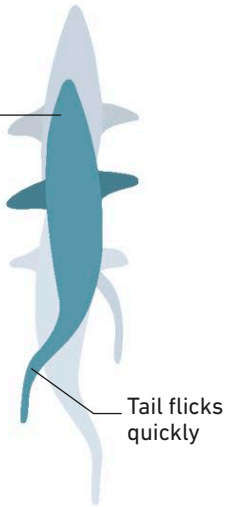
Whole body moves like a snake

Side to side
Long, thin fish, such as eels, propel themselves using a series of fast S-shaped movements through the water.



Body is steady and stays in a straight line

Body and tail
Many fish, including salmon, swim with the help of their body and tail, using their powerful flank muscles to move forward.

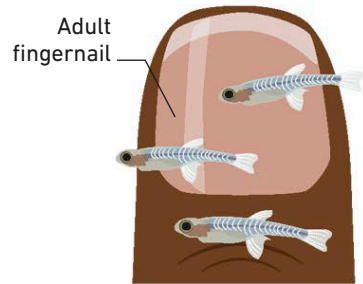


Tail flicks quickly

Strong tail
The fastest fish, from tuna to sharks, maintain a straight, streamlined body, while their flank muscles flick their tail from side to side.

SMALLEST FISH

PAEDOCYPRIS PROGENETICA IS THE SMALLEST-KNOWN FISH, WITH FEMALES MEASURING JUST **5/16 IN** (7.9 mm).



Adult fingernail

ENDEMIC SPECIES

Some fish are native to a specific habitat and do not stray from there—they are endemic to that region. This is because these fish have evolved to adapt in that area only, and they cannot survive for long anywhere else.



Coelacanths were thought to be extinct for 65 million years, but in 1938 scientists discovered them off the coast of southeastern Africa. Since then, an Indonesian coelacanth has also been found.



Elephantnose fish are a curious-looking freshwater species native to western and central Africa. They are found in slow-moving rivers and muddy pools.

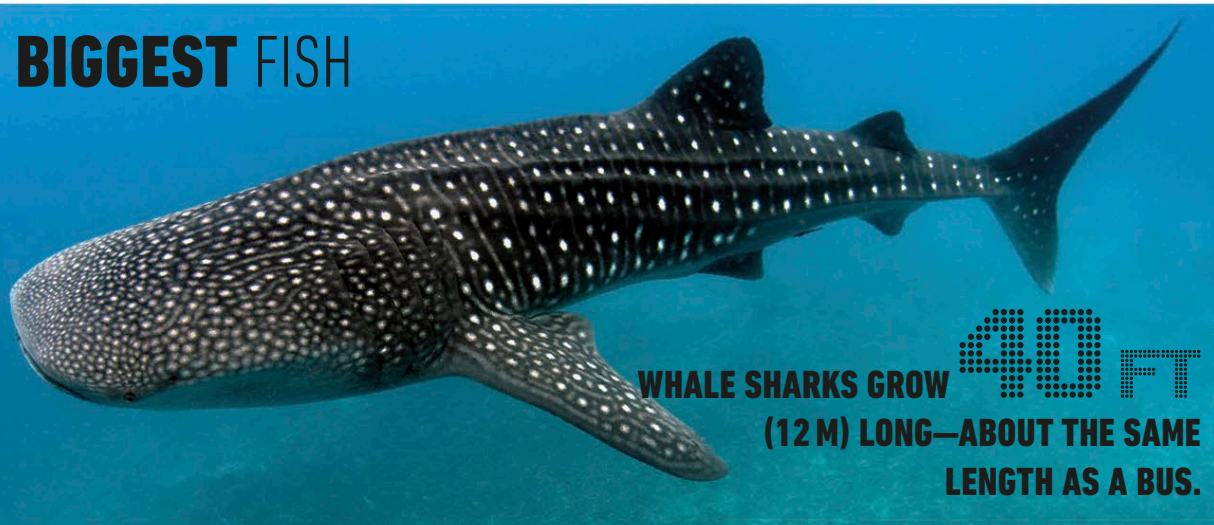
DEEPEST FISH

At the bottom of the Pacific Ocean is the Mariana Trench, the deepest oceanic trench in the world. Incredibly, some fish survive in this cold, dark, and lonely place, including the Mariana snailfish—a pink, slimy species that looks like an oversize tadpole.

MARIANA SNAILFISH CAN REACH DEPTHS OF **23,000 FT** (7,010 M)



BIGGEST FISH



WHALE SHARKS GROW 40 FT (12 M) LONG—ABOUT THE SAME LENGTH AS A BUS.

SMART FISH

Found in the Indian and Pacific oceans, the reef-dwelling tuskfish can use a rock to smash open shellfish, making it the first wild fish observed using tools.



FASTEST FISH

Named for their spectacular dorsal fin, sailfish would easily win a race against the fastest human swimmer. They live in the warm Atlantic and Indo-Pacific waters.

MICHAEL PHELPS OLYMPIC SWIMMER AT 4.7 MPH (7.6 KPH)



SAILFISH AT 70 MPH (113 KPH)

